Begin with Why, Not with AI

Audience: Service delivery managers
Parallel track: Service engineers work hands-on with GitHub Copilot and present their results later in the session.
Principle: Start with business needs and capabilities, not technology. Tools come last.

Purpose

Explore how AI can support our business goals. By the end of the session we have:

1. A shared view of where AI can make a difference for the business.
2. A picture of what is already possible, shown by our own service engineers.
3. A shortlist of candidate use cases.

Suggested flow

#	Block	Focus
1	What does the business need?	Strategy and context (Part 1)
2	Where do we want to be?	Target state and capability gaps (Part 2)
3	How do we get there?	Use cases, value, processes and systems, standardization, people, first steps (Part 3)
4	Engineer showcase	Engineers present workshop results
5	Reflect and decide	Share and collect ideas, fill in the prioritization template

Part 1 – Strategy and context: what does the business need?

Strategic goals

- What are our most important strategic goals for the coming years?
- Which measurable targets are linked to these goals (for example, SLA performance, customer satisfaction, cost per ticket)?
- Where could AI help us reach these targets?

Pain points

- Where do customers or employees lose the most time or experience the most friction today?
- Which recurring work costs us the most effort (for example, repeat incidents, ticket triage, changes, reporting)?
- Where do we miss SLAs, and why?

External drivers

- What are customers asking for or expecting from us?
- What do we know about how competitors use AI, and what results have they reported?
- Which regulations or compliance requirements cost us a lot of effort (for example, audit trails, reporting)?

Risk

- What are the risks of not using AI? (For example, falling behind competitors, rising costs, losing talent.)
- What are the risks of using AI? (For example, data privacy, quality of output, vendor dependency, reputation.)

Output

A short list of strategic goals and pain points where AI is plausibly relevant, plus the main external drivers and risks.

Part 2 – Target state: where do we want to be?

To-Be

- What would we like our customers to say about our service in three years?
- What does a good day look like for our service teams in that future?
- What would make customers choose us over a competitor?

Capabilities and gaps

- Which capabilities do we need for that future that are weak or missing today?
- What do we need to do better than we do now?
- For each gap: could AI help close it, or is something else needed first (process, people, data)?

Output

A one-page description of the To-Be state and the top capability gaps.

Part 3 – Making it real: how do we get there?

Candidate use cases

- Which candidate use cases follow from the goals, pain points and gaps we found?

Value and success

- What value would each use case bring? (For example, lower costs, more revenue, better quality, higher customer satisfaction, lower risk.)
- How do we define success, and how do we measure it? (Agree a baseline and KPIs before starting.)

Processes and systems

- Which processes and systems would each use case touch?

- Which upcoming systems will it need to work with?
- What does each use case depend on?

Foundation and reuse

- What do we need to clean up or standardize first so solutions can be reused across the organization? (For example, data quality, ways of working, guardrails, approved tools.)

People and change

- What does this mean for our people's roles and skills, and how do we bring them along?

First steps

- What is the smallest first step that would prove the value?

Output

Candidate use cases with KPIs, dependencies and a first step.

During the engineer showcase

All ideas are welcome. They do not need to be linked to the demos. While the engineers present, managers can capture ideas with these questions in mind:

- Which business need or capability gap does this idea address?
- What would the measurable impact be (time, cost, quality, customer satisfaction, risk)?
- Which processes and systems would this touch?
- What would have to be standardized to repeat this across teams?

Prioritization template

Fill in one row per candidate use case.

Use case	Business goal	Pain point / gap	KPI / baseline	Processes / systems / dependencies	Risk	First step	Value score	Feasibility score

Score each candidate on **value** and **feasibility** (low / medium / high). Start with high value and high feasibility.

Session outcomes

- Strategic goals and pain points where AI can help are listed.
- Top capability gaps and the To-Be picture are described.
- A shortlist of candidate use cases is scored on value and feasibility.
- Success measures are defined for the top candidates.
- Dependencies and a first step are identified for the top candidates.
- Standardization and clean-up needs are identified.